

FAIR and Square: making a static site support FAIR signposting

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Image: An image of a judge's hammer and gavel (Tingey Injury Lawfirm on Unsplash)

After my [previous post about Zotero ingest](#), I wondered what else I might be able to do to make this scholarly (and personal) blog more accessible, navigable, harvestable, and ingestable. One thing that occurred to me, that I had not implemented, is that I might make this blog **FAIR**. That is: [Findable, Accessible, Interoperable, and Reusable](#).

One of the ways one can work towards this is by implementing the [FAIR Signposting Profile](#). This is a series of in-document metadata elements, but also a linkset in the HTTP header returned by the blog. I am hosting with [Reclaim Hosting](#), who are using an Apache webserver to serve my static files. Normally I would curse this. Who's running Apache in this day and age? We have many more sophisticated technologies for serving websites. Even nginx would have been better, I would exclaim.

However, this is actually very useful in this circumstance. The Apache web server allows us to put `.htaccess` files in every directory. And directories are how my posts are structured. There is a directory with an `index.html` file inside it, so you don't have to see that it's a directory, it just looks like a path on the website. When you load `https://eve.gd/2026/06/23/making-blog-posts-harvestable-by-zotero-and-preserving-case-in-citation-fields/` the webserver looks in the blog folder on my server at `/2026/06/23/making-blog-posts-harvestable-by-zotero-and-preserving-case-in-citation-fields/` and serves you the `index.html` file. So you are getting `/2026/06/23/making-blog-posts-harvestable-by-zotero-and-preserving-case-in-citation-fields/index.html`. But it doesn't look like that to the user. However, really, all of these posts are in their own directories. And Apache can take directives from any one of them.

I made a plugin for my static site generator that creates a `.htaccess` file for every post that look like this:

```
<Files "index.html">
Header set Link "<https://orcid.org/0000-0002-5589-8511>; rel=\"author\",
<https://doi.org/10.59348/vrt01-f3b49>; rel=\"cite-as\",
<https://schema.org/BlogPosting>; rel=\"type\", <https://schema.org/AboutPage>;
rel=\"type\", <https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/>; rel=\"license\",
<https://eve.gd/2026/06/23/making-blog-posts-harvestable-by-zotero-and-preserving-case-
in-citation-fields/metadata.json>; rel=\"describedby\"; type=\"application/ld+json\";
profile=\"https://schema.org/\""
</Files>
<Files "metadata.json">
ForceType application/ld+json
</Files>
```

When the user's browser – or a machine agent – requests the page, it now gets the following HTTP headers:

```
HTTP/2 200
last-modified: Fri, 26 Jun 2026 22:19:49 GMT
accept-ranges: bytes
content-length: 25244
content-security-policy: upgrade-insecure-requests
strict-transport-security: max-age=31536000; includeSubDomains
x-xss-protection: 1; mode=block
x-frame-options: SAMEORIGIN
x-content-type-options: nosniff
referrer-policy: strict-origin-when-cross-origin
link: https://orcid.org/0000-0002-5589-8511; rel="author", https://doi.org/10.59348/vrt01-f3b49; rel="cite-as", https://schema.org/BlogPosting; rel="type", https://schema.org/AboutPage; rel="type", https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/; rel="license", https://eve.gd/2026/06/23/making-blog-posts-harvestable-by-zotero-and-preserving-case-in-citation-fields/metadata.json; rel="describedby"; type="application/ld+json"; profile="https://schema.org/"
content-type: text/html; charset=UTF-8
date: Sat, 27 Jun 2026 09:00:06 GMT
```

You can see that this allows us to get information about the page without even loading its full HTML content. Useful for machine access and discovery.

My Jekyll plugin also adds a `metadata.json` to every post directory. Here's an example of how that looks:

```

{
  "@context": "https://schema.org/",
  "@type": "BlogPosting",
  "name": "Making blog posts harvestable by Zotero and preserving case in citation fields",
  "headline": "Making blog posts harvestable by Zotero and preserving case in citation fields",
  "url": "https://eve.gd/2026/06/23/making-blog-posts-harvestable-by-zotero-and-preserving-case-in-citation-fields/",
  "inLanguage": "en-GB",
  "license": "https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/",
  "author": {
    "@type": "Person",
    "name": "Martin Paul Eve",
    "url": "https://eve.gd",
    "identifier": "https://orcid.org/0000-0002-5589-8511"
  },
  "datePublished": "2026-06-23",
  "identifier": "https://doi.org/10.59348/vrt01-f3b49",
  "citation": [
    {
      "@type": "BlogPosting",
      "@id": "https://paregorios.org/posts/2018/05/zotero_nikola_harmony/",
      "name": "Zotero-Nikola Harmony (One Simple Trick)",
      "url": "https://paregorios.org/posts/2018/05/zotero_nikola_harmony/",
      "datePublished": "2018-05-08",
      "inLanguage": "en",
      "license": "https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/",
      "author": {
        "@type": "Person",
        "name": "Tom Elliott",
        "@id": "https://orcid.org/0000-0002-4114-6677",
        "identifier": "https://orcid.org/0000-0002-4114-6677"
      },
      "isPartOf": {
        "@type": "Blog",
        "name": "paregorios.org",
        "url": "https://paregorios.org/"
      }
    }
  ]
}

```

There's descriptive metadata here, including license information, but also, coolly, we have citation information for pages that I cite. I have to enter these citation details manually, but it's good to be contributing to that ole citation network! To generate this, I add:

```
references:
  - type: BlogPosting
    title: "Zotero-Nikola Harmony (One Simple Trick)"
    url: "https://paregorios.org/posts/2018/05/zotero_nikola_harmony/"
    author:
      name: Tom Elliott
      orcid: "https://orcid.org/0000-0002-4114-6677"
    date: 2018-05-08
    language: en
    license: "https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/"
    isPartOf:
      type: Blog
      name: paregorios.org
      url: "https://paregorios.org/"
```

If you want, then, to verify that it's working, there's quite a good tool called [Signposting Sniffing](#), that plugs-into the Chrome browser and will show you whether your FAIR Signposts are working correctly. Here's my result so far and what it looks like:

A screenshot of a yellow banner displaying Signposting.org metadata. The text includes: 'this page is authored by https://orcid.org/0000-0002-5589-8511', 'this page should be cited as https://doi.org/10.59348/vrt01-t3b49', 'this page is of the type described at https://schema.org/BlogPosting', 'this page is of the type described at https://schema.org/AboutPage', 'this page is licensed according to https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/', and 'this page is described by https://eve.gd/2026/06/23/making-blog-posts-harvestable-by-zotero-and-preserving-case-in-citation-fields/metadata.json (application/vnd+json) with a profile at https://schema.org/'.

I also have a cool shortcut for self-citation. If I put this as a single line in the references section:

```
- https://eve.gd/2026/06/23/making-blog-posts-harvestable-by-zotero-and-preserving-
case-in-citation-fields/
```

That automatically generates the citation block:

```
{
  "@type": "BlogPosting",
  "@id": "https://doi.org/10.59348/6cr4z-4ct43",
  "name": "The Necessary Pain Involved in Blogging (if you want your work to be
preserved beyond your lifespan)",
  "url": "https://eve.gd/2026/04/19/the-necessary-pain-involved-in-blogging-if-you-
want-your-work-to-be-preserved-beyond-your-lifespan/",
  "datePublished": "2026-04-19",
  "inLanguage": "en-GB",
  "license": "https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/",
  "author": {
    "@type": "Person",
    "name": "Martin Paul Eve",
    "@id": "https://orcid.org/0000-0002-5589-8511",
    "identifier": "https://orcid.org/0000-0002-5589-8511"
  },
  "isPartOf": {
    "@type": "Blog",
    "name": "eve.gd: Martin Paul Eve",
    "url": "https://eve.gd"
  }
}
```

I can also do this for DOIs. Say I want to cite an academic article (I will use one of mine for now) I can just use:

```
- https://doi.org/10.31274/jlsc.16288 # preservation article
```

and it will produce, in the metadata.json :

```

{
  "@type": "ScholarlyArticle",
  "@id": "https://doi.org/10.31274/jlsc.16288",
  "name": "Digital Scholarly Journals Are Poorly Preserved: A Study of 7 Million
Articles",
  "url": "https://doi.org/10.31274/jlsc.16288",
  "author": {
    "@type": "Person",
    "name": "Martin Paul Eve",
    "affiliation": {
      "@type": "Organization",
      "name": "Crossref and Birkbeck, University of London"
    }
  },
  "datePublished": "2024-01-24",
  "publisher": {
    "@type": "Organization",
    "name": "Iowa State University"
  },
  "isPartOf": {
    "@type": "Periodical",
    "name": "Journal of Librarianship and Scholarly Communication"
  }
}

```

I will continue to improve the infrastructure of my blog in this way; it adds credence to the site, as well as helping with [the preservation effort I detailed before](#).

Finally, in [the Zotero post](#), I made reference to Tom Elliott's blog being defunct. Which it does seem to be. But he continues to have an online presence, on [Mastodon](#), [Bluesky](#), and the [web itself](#). We had a nice brief correspondence on Bluesky. I also spoke a bit with [Adam DJ Brett](#), who wanted to do a similar metadata enhancement to his blogs (so they could be Zotero cited). He [wrote up his adventures implementing Zotero pickup for blog posts](#) on his own site.